

# WORLD CODEX — COMPLETE REFERENCE

*Qinzhou · Orinthia · Magic · Ki · Spirit · Dual Awakened · Mechanics · Domains · World · Pacts · Arcadia · Vampires · Ashfall · Materials · Lore · Beastbound*

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## I. PHYSIOLOGY

Every living being is born with five internal organs governing power. Magic and Ki are **separate systems** with their own storage, channels, and failure modes.

| Organ             | System | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Damage Type     |
|-------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Mana Hall         | Magic  | Stores raw mana. Size at birth = talent cap. Expands slowly with training.                                                                                                                                                                            | Pathway Scorch  |
| Mana Pathways     | Magic  | Veins for mana. Width & flow rate determine casting speed and power throughput.                                                                                                                                                                       | Pathway Scorch  |
| Ki Core           | Ki     | Dense center in lower dantian. Stores refined ki/life energy. Grows via breath arts + body tempering.                                                                                                                                                 | Meridian Damage |
| Meridian Channels | Ki     | Network for ki circulation. Governs body enhancement. Blockage causes Meridian Damage.                                                                                                                                                                | Meridian Damage |
| Tenketsu Points   | Ki     | 361 nodes on the body where ki can be expelled. Closed by default. Open via training to use external ki constructs — clones, elemental shaping, puppet strings. Opening 1 tenketsu permanently costs 0.1% max ki pool. Opening all 361 = -36.1% pool. | Tenketsu Scorch |

### Tenketsu mechanics:

- Closed: Ki only reinforces body. Standard state.
- Open: Ki can leave body as constructs.
- Cost: Opening 1 tenketsu permanently costs 0.1% max ki pool. Opening all 361 = -36.1% pool.
- Counters: Still Casting + pressure point arts can strike tenketsu. Cold Iron needles pin

shut 1hr.

## II. AWAKENING

### Types

| Type             | Rate     | Description                                                                                |
|------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Single Awakening | 99%+     | Triggers Mana Hall OR Ki Core. Other stays dormant.                                        |
| Dual Awakening   | <0.01%   | Both systems active. 50% slower growth until True Core/Master stage, then synergy unlocks. |
| Failed Awakening | Majority | Both systems stay shut. No magic, no ki.                                                   |

### Age Risk

| Age   | Tier        | Note                     |
|-------|-------------|--------------------------|
| 6–8   | Genius Tier | Highest ceiling possible |
| 9–11  | Standard    | Normal potential         |
| 12–14 | Late        | –30% lower potential     |

**Testing:** Affinity Testing Crystals used worldwide. Touch crystal = glows color of affinities.  
~5% false negative rate.

### Regional Awakening Bias

| Region          | Magic | Ki  | Dual |
|-----------------|-------|-----|------|
| Orinthia (West) | 80%   | 19% | 1%   |
| Qinzhou (East)  | 19%   | 80% | 1%   |
| North           | 40%   | 60% | —    |
| South           | 70%   | 30% | —    |
|                 |       |     |      |

|          |        |        |        |
|----------|--------|--------|--------|
| Miraj    | 50%    | 50%    | —      |
| Frontier | Random | Random | Random |

## Racial Leans

| Race     | Magic | Ki  | Notes                                                   |
|----------|-------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Humans   | 50%   | 50% | Baseline split                                          |
| Elves    | 95%   | 5%  | Magically dominant                                      |
| Dwarves  | 30%   | 70% | Ki-dominant                                             |
| Beastkin | 10%   | 90% | Heavily ki-leaning                                      |
| Merfolk  | 99%   | 1%  | Almost pure magic                                       |
| Giants   | 15%   | 85% | Ki-dominant                                             |
| Vampires | 90%   | 10% | Blood→mana 2:1. Tri-Blooded common. High mana affinity. |

## III. MAGIC SYSTEM

### Core 6 Elemental Affinities

| Element | Description                                                       | Opposite |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Fire    | Combustion, heat, explosive force                                 | Water    |
| Water   | Flow, ice, blood manipulation, pressure. NO innate healing.       | Fire     |
| Wind    | Speed, cutting, flight, sound                                     | Earth    |
| Earth   | Defense, metal, gravity, terrain                                  | Wind     |
| Light   | Hard-light, rays, flash-blind, radiant burn, purification         | Dark     |
| Dark    | Shadow blades/tendrils, entropy drain, void zones, curse catalyst | Light    |

### Opposition & Combination Rules

- Opposition Rule:** Fire↔Water, Wind↔Earth, Light↔Dark = 10× cost if not innate.

- **Prism Rule:** 3+ affinities including opposites = penalty drops to 3× cost. 2+ affinities = "Prism Affinity."
- **Combination Law:** 2+ affinities = derivative magic. Fire+Earth = Magma. Water+Wind = Ice/Storm.

## Affinity Distribution

| Count        | %    | Note                                                |
|--------------|------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Affinity   | 70%  | Standard mage                                       |
| 2 Affinities | 25%  | Prism                                               |
| 3 Affinities | 4.9% | 3-element Prism                                     |
| 4 Affinities | 0.1% | True prodigy. Recorded history.                     |
| 5–6          | 0%   | Impossible naturally. Requires blessing/pact/relic. |

## Orinthia (West) Mage Ranks

*Rank Gate enforced — cannot cast above stage without Pathway Scorch.*

| # | Stage                | Art Tier       | Cost               | Example Spells                             |
|---|----------------------|----------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Awakened Stage       | Spark Spell    | Trivial            | Spark flame, breeze, drip water            |
| 2 | Adept Stage          | Combat Spell   | Light              | Fireball, stone wall, wind blade           |
| 3 | Expert Stage         | War Spell      | Heavy              | Flame lance, earth fort, lightning bolt    |
| 4 | Master Stage         | Siege Spell    | Extreme            | Firestorm, teleport squad, raise 30m wall  |
| 5 | Archmage Stage       | Disaster Spell | Extreme + External | Change weather, summon meteor              |
| 6 | Grand Archmage Stage | Calamity Spell | Beyond Mortal Hall | Region drought, sink island                |
| 7 | Sovereign Archon     | Law Spell      | Transcendent       | "No death in this city," "Time rewind 10s" |

Casting Methods

| Method              | Speed  | Power | Efficiency | Notes                                      |
|---------------------|--------|-------|------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Incantation Casting | 3–10s  | +40%  | +30%       | Most used for War Spell+                   |
| Quick Casting       | <1s    | Base  | Base       | No incantation. Standard for Spark/Combat. |
| Silent Casting      | Covert | –20%  | –20%       | No sound/movement. Master+ has no penalty. |

Specialized Magic Schools

Spirit · Rune · Alchemy · Curse · Sealing/Binding · Divination · Holy · Blood · Spatial · Time · Soulfire · Gravity · Mirror · Dream · Metal · Storm · Bone · Star · Decay/Entropy · Void · Beast King · Oath · Resonance · Plague · Illusion Master · Eclipse · Spirit Sovereign

IV. KI SYSTEM

Qinzhou (East) Cultivation Realms

Rank Gate enforced — cannot learn art above realm.

| # | Realm             | Art Tier     | Cost               | Example Arts                                   |
|---|-------------------|--------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Awakened Realm    | Pulse Art    | Trivial            | Reinforce punch, 10s sprint, night vision      |
| 2 | Refined Realm     | Flow Art     | Light              | Iron skin, leap 20m, shatter stone             |
| 3 | Tempered Realm    | Surge Art    | Heavy              | Faster than eyes, blade wind, steel body       |
| 4 | True Core Realm   | Manifest Art | Extreme            | Afterimage clones, ki blade, walk on air       |
| 5 | Grandmaster Realm | Domain Art   | Extreme + External | 100m pressure aura, suppress magic             |
| 6 | Saint Realm       | Edict Art    | Beyond Mortal Core | Mountain-split strike, body reform, live 500yr |
|   |                   |              |                    |                                                |

|   |                      |         |              |                                            |
|---|----------------------|---------|--------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 7 | Heaven-Opening Realm | Law Art | Transcendent | "I cannot be cut," "Step crosses 10 miles" |
|---|----------------------|---------|--------------|--------------------------------------------|

## Execution Methods

| Method        | Speed     | Power | Efficiency | Notes                                            |
|---------------|-----------|-------|------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Form Casting  | 2–5s kata | +40%  | +30%       | Standard for Surge Art+. Physical kata required. |
| Flash Casting | <1s       | Base  | Base       | No form. Standard duel default.                  |
| Still Casting | Covert    | –20%  | –20%       | Internal only. True Core+ has no penalty.        |

## Chakra Natures

Ki circulated through Mana Pathways + Meridians in specific patterns to gain elemental affinity. Costs ki, not mana. **Nullstone does NOT block.** Cold Iron does.

- **Basic Natures:** Fire, Water, Wind, Earth, Lightning. 1 month training per nature with matching mana crystal. Most learn 1–2.
- **Advanced Natures:** Ice = Water+Wind ki · Lava = Fire+Earth ki · Wood = Water+Earth+Yang. Requires Master Stage minimum.

## Chakra Control Training

| Technique          | Stage        | Description                                                                    |
|--------------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tree Walking       | Flow Stage   | Run ki to feet, stick to surfaces. Unlocks Surface Adherence.                  |
| Water Walking      | Surge Stage  | Emit ki from tenketsu to repel water. Unlocks Still Casting while in motion.   |
| Leaf Concentration | Master Stage | Stick leaf to forehead with ki. Unlocks Sigil Casting without drawing.         |
| Chakra Strings     | True Core+   | Tenketsu expel ki threads. Puppetry, weapon control, Borrowed Casting to ally. |

## Art Scrolls

- Ki equivalent of Spell Tomes. Written in Fleshscript on preserved skin.

- Learning: 3× slower than tutelage. 10% mislearn = Meridian Damage.
- Forbidden Scrolls: Arcadia Archive holds Law Art scrolls. Reading below Edict Stage = instant Pathway Scorch + Meridian Damage.

## **Eight Meridian Gates**

Voluntary limiters in Meridians. Opening floods ki past safe levels. Gate 3+ counts as overdraw = Meridian Damage on close. Oathslate can forbid Gate 8 in military contracts.

| # | Gate            | Location      | Bonus                                      | Risk                                | Stage Req |
|---|-----------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------|
| 1 | Gate of Opening | Brain         | Flash Casting –50% cost                    | 1hr fatigue                         | Flow      |
| 2 | Gate of Rest    | Brain         | Stamina regen 5×                           | Muscles tear, 1 day bed rest        | Flow      |
| 3 | Gate of Life    | Spinal cord   | Skin red. +1 Stage strength/speed          | Meridian Damage = Combat Spell      | Surge     |
| 4 | Gate of Pain    | Spinal cord   | Ignore pain. Visible ki aura               | –20% max ki pool 1 week             | Surge     |
| 5 | Gate of Limit   | Abdomen       | +2 Stages. Move = air ignites              | Hair white. 50% chance cripple limb | Manifest  |
| 6 | Gate of View    | Stomach       | Punch = shockwave. Void Steps free         | Internal bleeding                   | Manifest  |
| 7 | Gate of Wonder  | Below stomach | Aura = Domain Art pressure. Blue steam     | Bones crack. 1 month recovery       | Domain    |
| 8 | Gate of Death   | Heart         | +5 Stages for 5min. All stats Law Art tier | See penalties below                 | Edict     |

### **Gate of Death — Survival Outcomes (when 5-minute timer ends):**

- **Normal person:** Death. No revival. No blessing saves you.
- **Temperance Blessing:** Survive. –99% max ki pool permanent. All Gates locked forever. –90% remaining lifespan.
- **Ascended:** Survive. –80% max ki permanent. Cindered state = –50% all physical stats permanent. Gates 1–7 locked.

- **Ascended + Temperance:** Survive. –50% max ki permanent. Gate 8 locked forever. 1 year coma after use.

## Sage Mode — Land Pact Fusion

- **Requirement:** Active Land Pact with Land Bound Spirit.
- **Method:** Enter Still Casting, open tenketsu. Spirit floods world-ki for 10 minutes.
- **Effect:** +2 Stages, sensory range 10 miles, all physical stats up. Ki Arts gain land element.
- **Risk:** Move during spirit intake = petrify = Meridian Damage ×3. Corrupted land = madness.
- **Cooldown:** Land spirit recharges 1 week.

## V. SPIRIT SYSTEM

### Spirit Types

| Type       | Lean   | Description                                                               |
|------------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Elemental  | Magic  | Fire, Water, Wind, Earth, Light, Dark, Lightning, Ice, Metal, Space, etc. |
| Beast      | Ki     | Tiger, Dragon, Phoenix, Turtle, Wolf. Boost Ki techniques.                |
| Ancestor   | Either | Dead masters. Teach arts/spells. Honor-based bond.                        |
| Weapon     | Either | Born in legendary blades/armor. Self-repair, manifests art/spell.         |
| Concept    | Either | Rare. "Sword," "Mountain," "Silence." Grant technique-like boosts.        |
| Eastern Ki | Ki     | Breath Wisps, Iron Koi, Storm Tigers, Moon Rabbits.                       |

### Pact Rules

- **Spirit Gets:** Experience and growth · Mana or ki energy · Evolution chance
- **User Gets:** +20–50% power boost · –20–50% cost on element · Autonomous spirit action · Sensory link
- Mutual benefit only. No dominance. No backlash on breaking (unless betrayal).
- NO Greater Forms. A Water spirit will not grant blood magic.



- Multiple spirits: very rare. Discord if opposites. Charity blessing negates discord.
- Royal Spirit: maximum 1 per person.
- **Hollowed:** Each pact tithes % of pool. Reach 100% total = Hollowed = NPC for spirits.

## Spirit Pact Costs

| Stage     | Tithe | Time Cost                                 | Mental Cost           | Limit                 |
|-----------|-------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| Minor     | 3%    | Whispers, 1 Combat Spell/day              | Faint whispers        | Can hold 3–5          |
| True      | 8%    | 1hr/week communion required               | Occasional dreams     | Can hold 2–3          |
| Noble     | 15%   | Spirit votes on decisions. Daily presence | Daily presence        | 1–2 max, jealous      |
| Earl      | 20%   | Manifests 1hr/day physically              | Mood bleed            | 1 only, demands focus |
| Royal     | 30%   | Co-inhabits, sees memories                | Identity echoes       | 1 only, no others     |
| Sovereign | 50%   | Shares body control in crisis             | Sense loss if angered | 1 only, legendary     |

**Unity Form:** Royal/Sovereign only, after decades of trust + life-death moment. Temporary = 5min max, power +1 stage, 3 days exhaustion. Permanent fusion = myth, 1 per 10,000 years.

**Multiple Spirits:** Each pact stacks regen tithe. 3× True = –24% total. Conflicting spirits = civil war in soul. Most stop at 2. East shamans run “spirit courts” of 5 Minor spirits.

## Spirit Tiers

| Tier   | Visibility                   | Power Boost | Cost Reduction | Rarity                                     |
|--------|------------------------------|-------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Lesser | Flicker/wisp                 | +20–30%     | –20–30%        | Common                                     |
| Noble  | Human silhouette, 5m weather | +40–60%     | –40–50%        | Rare — 1 per region                        |
| Royal  | 50m elemental weather        | +80–120%    | –60–70%        | 1–3 per element globally. Political event. |
|        |                              |             |                |                                            |

|           |              |                |   |                        |
|-----------|--------------|----------------|---|------------------------|
| Sovereign | Doesn't pact | Blessings only | — | Born from Spirit Realm |
|-----------|--------------|----------------|---|------------------------|

## Spirit Evolution

- **Lesser → Noble:** 300–500 years of pacts, OR 1 lifelong pact with a genius/Prism user.
- **Noble → Royal:** 1000+ years of pacts, OR a world-changing event with contractor.
- **Royal → Sovereign:** Never via pact. Sovereigns are born from the Spirit Realm itself.

## VI. DUAL AWAKENED

- **Rarity:** <0.01% of population.
- **Growth Penalty:** 50% slower in both systems until True Core/Master. Then synergy unlocks.
- **Combat Conflict:** Cannot use Incantation + Form Casting simultaneously. Exception: Temperance blessing OR Saint+/Grandmaster+ control.
- **Allowed Combos:** Quick + Flash OR Silent + Still — both at 2× resource cost.
- **Synergy Arts (True Core/Master+):** Spellblade · Ki-Mana Armor · Domain Fusion
- **Peak Cap:** Heaven-Opening Realm / Sovereign Archon Stage. Only 2–3 individuals in recorded history reached this as dual-awakened.

## VII. MECHANICS

### Failure States

**Pathway Scorch** — Magic overdraw / Light vs Duskwalker / extra Fleshscript. Recovery = base ×0.5 to ×3.0 depending on talent, age, healing, will, and aspect.

| Stage        | Natural Heal | + Aetherium |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|
| Adept/Expert | ~1 month     | ~10 days    |
| Master       | ~6 months    | ~2 months   |
| Grandmaster  | ~2 years     | ~8 months   |
|              |              |             |

|           |                 |                                        |
|-----------|-----------------|----------------------------------------|
| Archmage+ | Permanent (80%) | Worldroot + Saint healer = 5yr for 20% |
|-----------|-----------------|----------------------------------------|

**Meridian Damage** — Ki overdraw / break Form mid-Edict / open Gate 3+. –50% max ki.  
Random Art 50% fail 1 month.

| Stage           | Recovery              |
|-----------------|-----------------------|
| Adept/Refined   | ~1 month              |
| Expert/Tempered | ~6 months             |
| Grandmaster+    | Death or crippled 90% |

**Oathbacklash** — Break an Oathslate contract.

- Mechanical: Pathway Scorch + Meridian Damage simultaneously. –80% both pools 1 month.
- Social: Permanent Oathbreaker brand. Future Oathslates crack at touch. No bank/merchant/guild trust.
- Clean Break: Law Spell "I deny this oath" — costs caster 10 years lifespan.

**Script Fever** — Holding 4+ active Fleshscripts simultaneously.

- Effect: –5% max pool per extra script, permanent.
- Removal: Remove scripts surgically — stat loss stays.

**Tenketsu Scorch** — Tenketsu forced shut.

- Effect: –10% ki output per 36 closed.
- Recovery: 1 week per 36, or healing art.

**Resonance Cascade** — 5% chance when Prism uses 3+ elements at once. Elements fuse into new derivative permanently. Cannot be controlled or predicted.

**Leyline Boost** — Passive bonus when standing on a leyline. –30% cost on all spells/arts.  
Royal spirit on leyline = War/Siege spells cast for free.

## Cold Iron Poisoning

No permanent loss. While worn: –80% flow + cumulative –5% max pool per hour, caps at –50%.

- 1hr: –85% current, –5% max pool. Fighting at ~10% power.

- 10hr: –80% current, –50% max pool. Cantrip only.
- Remove + 1 day rest: 100% recovery. No permanent crippling.

## Anti-Magic/Ki Materials

- **Nullstone:** Complete mana/ki block, 1–10m radius dead zone. Pure brute force to escape. Cancels Cold Iron –80% drain — must choose block vs drain, not both.
- **Cold Iron:** –80% mana/ki flow. Worn: cumulative –5% max pool per hour, caps at –50%. Remove + 1 day = 100% recovery. Inside Nullstone = just durable metal.

## Learning Arts/Spells

| Method                    | Speed            | Notes                                                          |
|---------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tutelage                  | Fastest          | Direct from master or manual. 1–6 months for Combat/Flow tier. |
| Spell Tomes / Art Scrolls | 3× slower        | 10% mislearn = Pathway Scorch or Meridian Damage.              |
| Observation               | Quick/Flash only | –30% power until mastered. Eye Pact = instant mastery.         |
| Spirit Teaching           | 5× faster        | Only works for the spirit's own element.                       |

Rank Gate enforced — cannot learn/cast above current stage.

## Creating New Arts/Spells

- Requirement: Must already have all elements/aspects involved.
- Spark/Pulse: Weeks. Combat/Flow: Months, 100+ test casts. War/Surge: Years. Siege/Manifest+: Team + lifetime.
- Methods: Derivative fusion · Principle derivation · Spirit co-creation · Inspiration trauma
- Creator names their art. Arcadia validates and registers into the Archive.
- Not everyone creates — some create original techniques, some refine inherited ones, some only master existing arts.

## Items

- **Mundane foci/staves/robes:** Preference only. No mechanical boost.

- **Artifacts & Relics:** Can grant –30% cost, Auto-Silent Casting, unique techniques. Tracked by factions. Fought over. Relic pacts possible.

## VIII. DOMAINS & TERRITORIES

Domain Expansion (Mana) and Territory Expansion (Ki) are reality-marble techniques at the same power tier — different axes.

### Shared Rules

| Rule         | Detail                                                                                                                      |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stage Req    | Archmage / Domain Realm minimum. Sovereign Archon / Edict Realm for Open Barrier.                                           |
| Signature    | 1 War Spell / Surge Art used 1,000+ times. Imprints as the field law.                                                       |
| Casting      | Incantation 5–15s. Can move but –20% barrier HP and +2s cast time. Standing still = max stability. Quick/Silent impossible. |
| Cost         | 80–90% max mana/ki upfront. Fail = Pathway Scorch ×2 + 1 week coma.                                                         |
| Cooldown     | Cannot cast above Combat Spell / Flow Art for 1hr after. Mana Hall / Meridians are frayed.                                  |
| Barrier      | 50–100m radius. HP = 0.5× your max pool. Forms instantly from pressure.                                                     |
| Duration     | Archmage/Domain: 45s · Grand Archmage: 2min · Sovereign Archon/Edict: 4min                                                  |
| Clash        | Overlapping fields: stronger pool + stage wins. Loser takes Pathway Scorch + 1hr silence.                                   |
| Open Barrier | Sovereign Archon / Edict only. 300m radius, no barrier, no sure-hit. 95% cost. Cannot be dispelled from outside.            |

### Mana Domain — Sure-Hit Reality

- Sure-Hit: Signature spell auto-targets all inside. Still costs mana per hit.
- Buff: +50% power, +30% efficiency to all spells matching domain element.
- Land Pact Bonus: Cast in bonded land = +25% barrier HP, +30s duration.

### Ki Territory — Physical Law Alteration

- **Sure-Hit:** Physical laws altered. Signature art effects cannot miss in melee range. Enemy physics penalized.
- **Buff:** +50% power, +30% efficiency to matching arts. Domain Realm aura suppresses magic inside.
- **No Spell Sure-Hit:** Cannot auto-cast Lightning Bolt. But CAN make "you cannot dodge my fist" — true.

## Counters

- **External Break:** 3× Calamity Spell / Siege Art within 10s shatters barrier. Caster takes Pathway Scorch.
- **Internal Deny (Simple Domain):** Flow Stage+ ki tech. Emit ki to neutralize sure-hit for 5s. Costs 20% ki per 5s.
- **Law Spell "No law in this place":** Sovereign Archon only. Cancels field. Costs caster 5 years lifespan.
- **Escape Window:** Exit barrier within 2s after chant ends. Void Steps / Wind flight work.
- **Cold Iron:** Prevents cast if worn. Does NOT stop an already-active field.

## Dual Awakened — Domain Fusion

- **Imprint:** 1 spell + 1 art combined.
- **Cost:** 100% mana + 100% ki. Cast time 10s. Can move while casting.
- **Beast Unity:** Unity state allows use of Beast's domain/territory 1/day. Counts as your field use.

## Example Fields

**Coffin of Searing Sky** (Mana Domain) — Fire Archmage. Sig: Flame Lance. All fire spells sure-hit. Air ignites. Non-Fire resistance –50%. 80m barrier.

**Hall of Unbroken Kata** (Ki Territory) — Domain Realm Grandmaster. Sig: Mountain Root. Gravity 5× for enemies. Caster immune. Melee strikes cannot miss in 10m. 90m barrier.

**Red Sky Prison** (Domain Fusion) — Dual Awakened Sovereign Archon / Edict. Sig: Flame Lance + Mountain Root. Lava sure-hit burn + 5× gravity crush. Cost: 100% mana + 100% ki. 10s moving cast.

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## IX. WORLD — REGIONS

### Qinzhou (East)

**Theme:** Cultivation civilization **Major Powers:** Orthodox Alliance · Unorthodox Alliance · Demonic Sect · Eastern Imperial Family · Eastern Religion · Hao Sect **Sect Hierarchy:** Sect masters → Grand elders → Elders → Hall masters → Inner disciples → Outer disciples → Trainees/servants/attached followers **Core Logic:**

- Extreme peak power but fragmented and difficult to unify
- Hao Sect = top intelligence & covert operations
- Sects and clans can recruit each other
- Politically unstable, not constantly at war

### Orinthia (West)

**Theme:** Feudal-knightly civilization **Major Powers:** King and royal court · Holy City · Great Noble Houses · Knight Orders · Mage Institutions · Merchant Guilds · The Veiled Order **Military Structure:** Royal knight order · Holy knight order · Noble house knight orders · Magic knights · Battle mages · Paladin orders · Crusader units **Core Logic:**

- Strong in logistics, organization, combined arms
- Holy City has largest single knight order
- Noble houses combined field more knight power than either individually
- The Veiled Order handles espionage & counterintelligence

### North

**Theme:** Arctic survival against monsters **Factions:** Frostwarden Holds · Order of the Black Lantern · Icebound Clans · Sealing Orders · Forge-City Councils · Monster Hunter Leagues **Key Cities:** Rimegate · Hearthwall · Northwatch Bastion · Skeldhollow **Logic:** Survives through fortification, discipline, monster-hunting. Sealing and containment matter as much as warfare.

### South

**Theme:** Ancient, mystical, nature-heavy **Factions:** Verdant Courts · Rootwardens · Sun Priests · Temple City-States · Coastal and Island Powers **Logic:** Elven kingdom centered on the World Tree. Elven throne matriarchal — females only. Old magic, spirit traditions, sacred sovereignty.

## Frontier

**Theme:** Dangerous neutral belt between Qinzhou and Orinthia **Content:** Ruins · Relics · Black markets · Dungeon belts · Mercenaries · Border forts · Monster zones **Purpose:** World's pressure valve and trade corridor.

## Kingdom of Miraj

**Theme:** Desert kingdom **Powers:** King · Nobles · Oasis cities · Caravan routes · Desert knight orders **Power Base:** Trade, water control, relic routes, desert survival.

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## X. WORLD — RACES

| Race      | Strengths                                                 | Weakness               | Kingdom/Organization                               |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Humans    | Adaptable, widespread                                     | Fragmented             | No unified kingdom — Qinzhou, Orinthia, Miraj      |
| Elves     | Spirit magic, healing, longevity, World Tree              | Tied to sacred land    | True kingdom — queen/matriarch, female throne only |
| Dwarves   | Forge-cities, rune-craft, siege engineering               | Slow to expand         | Mountain kingdom                                   |
| Merfolk   | Currents, reefs, underwater cities, naval routes          | Weak inland            | Sea kingdom                                        |
| Giants    | Ancient power, territorial control, lineage, raw strength | Sparse                 | Own kingdom                                        |
| Beastkin  | Flexible, adaptable                                       | Decentralized          | Tribes, packs, clans, seasonal confederations      |
| Vampires  | Dangerous, magically blessed                              | Vulnerable to exposure | Hidden cities or kingdoms                          |
| Dragonkin | Powerful, rare                                            | Rare and isolated      | Offspring of pure dragons                          |
| Dragons   | Apex beings                                               | Extremely rare         | No kingdom — may make pacts                        |
| Angels    | Heaven-born power                                         | Extremely rare         | Heaven — may descend and make pacts                |



|         |                    |                      |                                    |
|---------|--------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------|
| Demons  | Hell-born power    | Extremely rare       | Hell — may cross into mortal world |
| Spirits | Spirit Realm power | Tied to sacred sites | Spirit Realm                       |

## Additional Races

**Dark Elves:** Elves banished from the World Tree. Lose plant-based ki/magic. Gain +20% Dark/Earth affinity, +10% Earth resistance. Lifespan 400–600 years. Found Underground, Frontier, South. Crossbow-Shadow Magic and ki users common.

**Duskwalkers:** Child of Shadowling race + Dark spirit + human/elf. Skin grey/black, absorbs light. Daylight –20% all stats. Night +30% Silent/Sigil Casting. Shadow step 5m once per min. Counter: Light Magic = Shadow Burn = Pathway Scorch. Holy Magic roots 10s.

## Ascension — Universal Rule

- **Trigger:** Reach Sovereign Archon / Heaven-Opening Realm, then break mortal limit in a life-death moment. 1 per 100,000 years globally.
- **Changes:** Lifespan ×5 to ×10. New baseline = old peak. Growth cap removed. Nullstone doesn't suppress. Cold Iron drains 50% not 80%.
- **One Time:** Cannot ascend twice.
- **Drawbacks:** None. Can still die. Still need food/sleep/air.
- **Immortality:** Not granted by ascension alone. Practically impossible for humans.

## XI. WORLD — INTELLIGENCE NETWORKS

| Region          | Organizations                                                                                                 |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Qinzhou (East)  | Hao Sect · Shadow networks · Clan assassins · Merchant informant webs · Orthodox and unorthodox intel circles |
| Orinthia (West) | The Veiled Order · Royal spies · Church inquisitors · Noble house intel networks · Merchant guild informants  |
| North           | Scouts · Smugglers · Seal guardians · Hunter networks                                                         |
| South           | Forest watchers · Temple spies · Caravan informants · Island smugglers                                        |

|          |                                                                     |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
|          |                                                                     |
| Frontier | Mercenaries · Smugglers · Relic brokers · Border lords · Ruin-cults |

## XII. WORLD — BALANCE, THEMES & NAMING

### Balance Rules:

- Every major region controls something essential and lacks something essential.
- Combat power, politics, economy, influence, and covert power all matter.
- No faction should be fully self-sufficient.
- The world should feel like interlocking civilizations, not one dominant empire.

### Major World Themes:

- Regional power is distributed, not concentrated.
- Internal rivalries matter as much as external enemies.
- Neutral institutions keep the world connected.
- Education and guilds shape future political leaders.
- Monster ecology is regional and political.
- The Spirit Realm is a real third system.
- Rare powers should exist outside Heaven and Hell.
- The sealed continent remains the greatest unknown.

### Naming Conventions:

| Region          | Style                                                |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Qinzhou (East)  | Sect, hall, peak, spirit, cultivation, martial names |
| Orinthia (West) | House, order, keep, cathedral, court, noble names    |
| Arcadia         | Neutral, scholarly, cross-cultural names             |
| Miraj           | Oasis, dune, sun, caravan, crown, desert names       |
| North           | Frost, seal, wall, bastion, hunt names               |
|                 |                                                      |

|          |                                                   |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------|
| South    | Tree, grove, root, spirit, dawn, tide names       |
| Frontier | Relic, ruin, gate, border, ward, expedition names |

## XIII. ECONOMY & CONTRACTS

**Currency:** 1 Gold = 20 Silver = 400 Bronze = 4,000 Copper. Peasant wage: 2–5 Bronze/day.

### **Mercenary Rates:**

| Rank                 | Rate            | Notes                          |
|----------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|
| Awakened/Pulse       | 2–5 Silver/day  | +50% hazard vs monsters        |
| Adept/Flow           | 1–3 Gold/day    | +100% vs War Spell tier        |
| Expert/Surge         | 5–15 Gold/day   | Double if outnumbered          |
| Master/Manifest      | 50–200 Gold/day | Triple for Siege/Calamity foes |
| Archmage/Grandmaster | Negotiated      | Kingdom budget                 |
| Dual Awakened        | ×5 base rate    | ×2 hazard multiplier           |

### **Oathslate Contracts:**

- Written pact on Oathslate = unbreakable unless slate is physically destroyed.
- Break = Oathbacklash: Pathway Scorch + Meridian Damage simultaneously. –80% both pools 1 month.
- Permanent Oathbreaker brand. Future Oathslates crack at touch. No bank/merchant/guild trust.
- Clean Break: Law Spell “I deny this oath” — costs caster 10 years lifespan.
- Used for: banks, merchant houses, marriage bonds, mage guild charters, Nine Coins contracts.

## XIV. BLOODLINE TRAITS

Minor +10% flavor only. Affinity tradeoffs. Not crippling. A Sunblessed mage can still cast Water spells at 95% efficiency vs 105% for Fire.

| Region          | Trait          | Bonuses                                            | Penalty                 |
|-----------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| North           | Frostborn      | +10% Ice/Earth resist, +5% Ice/Earth affinity      | –5% Fire affinity       |
| South           | Sunblessed     | +10% Light/Fire affinity, +5% Light/Fire resist    | –5% Dark/Water affinity |
| Qinzhou (East)  | Spirit-Touched | +1 Spirit Pact slot, +10% spirit communication     | –5% Beast affinity      |
| Orinthia (West) | Beastblood     | +10% Beast Ki affinity, +5% physical strength      | –5% Wind affinity       |
| Miraj           | Sandwalker     | Ignore desert heat/sandstorms, +10% Earth affinity | –5% Water affinity      |
| Arcadia         | Skyborn        | +10% Wind/Lightning affinity, +5% reaction speed   | –5% Earth affinity      |
| Frontier        | Scarred        | +20% pain tolerance, +10% backlash resistance      | –5% healing speed       |
| Tri-Blooded     | Pick 2         | +5% each from any 2 traits                         | –2.5% each penalty      |

## XV. HEAVEN & HELL

**Structure:** Heaven = 7 Heavens, each ruled by one virtue. Hell = 7 Hells, each ruled by one deadly sin. **Pact Rule:** A transcendent being can maintain only ONE active contractor at a time. Motivation: interest, favor, curiosity, or mutual benefit. No dominion pacts.

| Sin   | Countered By | Sin Theme                       | Virtue Theme                          | Sin Pact Gift                         | Virtue Blessing Gift          |
|-------|--------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Pride | Humility     | Dominance, presence, command    | Concealment, reduced notice, anti-ego | Command presence, dominance aura      | Concealment, anti-ego effects |
| Greed | Charity      | Accumulation, binding, claiming | Sharing power, healing, protection    | Accumulation, binding, claiming power | Share power, heal, protect    |

|          |            |                                             |                                          |                                                |                                         |
|----------|------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Lust     | Chastity   | Charm, allure, vitality, obsession          | Purity, resistance to corruption         | Charm, emotional pull, vitality                | Purity, corruption resistance           |
| Envy     | Kindness   | Mimicry, adaptation, undermining            | Calming, soothing, stabilization         | Mimicry, adaptation, copying                   | Calm, soothe, stabilize                 |
| Gluttony | Temperance | Absorption, devouring, power theft          | Balance, regulation, mixed power control | Absorb powers and make them your own           | Balance, regulate, control mixed power  |
| Wrath    | Patience   | Hellfire, explosive destruction, escalation | Endurance, scaling strength over time    | Hellfire, destructive force, battle escalation | Endurance, scaling strength             |
| Sloth    | Diligence  | Conservation, stasis, oppressive efficiency | Mastery, consistency, rapid improvement  | Conservation, stasis, oppressive efficiency    | Mastery, consistency, rapid improvement |

## XVI. PACTS & BLESSINGS

### Eye Pacts (Hereditary Bloodline)

- Passed genetically through a bloodline. Only one person per generation normally awakens.
- Multiple different bloodlines can exist simultaneously.
- **Possible Powers:** Command eyes · Truth-seeing eyes · Future-sight eyes · Time-linked eyes · Copy eyes · Soul eyes · Space eyes · Judgment eyes · Elemental eyes

### Soul Pacts

**Sources:** Ancestors · Guardian spirits · Saintly remnants · Deathless souls · Other soul-aligned intelligences **Gifts:** Soul armor · Spirit sight · Soul healing · Ancestral memory · Possession resistance · Spirit projection · Soul pressure · Resonance with sacred sites and relics

### Other Pact Types

| Type               | Description                                                                    | Gifts                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Beast Pacts        | Animal, primal, spirit-animal bonds                                            | Transformation traits · Tracking · Feral instincts · Pack-links · Bonded mounts                                                                                                         |
| Elemental Pacts    | Fire, frost, storm, earth, other elemental mastery                             | Full elemental control · Advanced affinity                                                                                                                                              |
| Relic Pacts        | Ancient weapons or artifacts choose a bearer                                   | Legendary techniques · Relic awakening · Memory inheritance                                                                                                                             |
| Knowledge Pacts    | Bonds with archives, memory entities, sages, star-records                      | Rapid learning · Hidden history · Strategy · Pattern recognition                                                                                                                        |
| Land Pacts         | With Land Bound Spirits                                                        | 10% pool tithe · Defend territory · Within 10 miles: +1 Stage power, sense hostile intent, cast through terrain · Break = Oathbreaker brand, –50% pool 1 year, can't make new Land Pact |
| Relic Pacts (Item) | Artifact bonds with 5% tithe — example: Wraithweave suit = Auto-Silent Casting | Break = relic hunts you                                                                                                                                                                 |

## Gluttony Blessing

- **Source:** Demon Prince of Consumption
- **Effect:** On killing blow vs mage/ki user, steal 1 Spell/Art they knew.
- **Limit:** Hold 3 stolen abilities max. Steal 4th = must erase 1 of previous 3 forever.
- **Cost:** Stolen abilities cost 2x mana/ki. Use your talent tier, not theirs.
- **Tell:** Eyes flash victim's element when used. Divination reveals theft mark.

## Other Blessings

| Blessing   | Effect                                            |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Temperance | Dual Awakened growth penalty removed permanently. |
| Unbowed    | Magical compulsion/fear/charm fail permanently.   |
|            |                                                   |

|               |                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scribe's Hand | Learn/teach 5× speed permanently.                                                                                                      |
| Bridge        | Link 3 people for life. Share pools+senses 10min/day. Member dies = Pathway Scorch + 1mo coma for survivors. Can re-link after 1 year. |
| Years         | Age 90% slower permanently. Disease immunity.                                                                                          |
| Verdant Heart | Plants obey permanently. Healing 10× in 100m radius.                                                                                   |

## Pure Dragon Blessings — 1 per person max

One dragon per element. Each grants Affinity Surge + Draconic Art. Core rules: permanent for life, no revocation, no conduct clauses.

| Dragon           | Affinity Surge                                            | Draconic Art                                                   | Tell                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Fire Dragon      | +50% Fire dmg, −50% Fire taken                            | Dragon's Breath 1/day — War Spell fire cone, no cast time      | Slit pupils. Skin warm.                   |
| Water Dragon     | Breathe water. Water −30%. Ignore pressure                | Tidal Claim 1/day — command 100m water 1min                    | Veins blue when wet. Always damp.         |
| Wind Dragon      | Void Steps free. Wind +40% speed                          | Storm Wing 1/hr — flight 1min, 2× run speed                    | Hair always moves. Voice carries.         |
| Earth Dragon     | Cannot be moved below Edict/Law. Earth +40% def           | Mountain Root 1/day — immovable 30s, shockwave after           | Stone skin texture. Heavy steps.          |
| Light Dragon     | Ignore darkness/illusion/invisible. Light ignores resists | Sunbrand 1/day — melee = Siege Spell vs Dark/undead            | Faint shadow in full dark. Eyes glow dim. |
| Dark Dragon      | Daylight −20% not −40%. Dark +50% at night                | Nightfall 1/day — 100m magical darkness 1min, you see normally | Cast no shadow. Cold touch.               |
| Lightning Dragon | Reaction +1 tier. Lightning chains 2 extra targets        | Bolt Step 1/hr — 50m lightning teleport, passes barriers       | Hair static. Ozone when angry.            |
| Ice              | Immune mundane cold.                                      | Winter's Claim 1/day —                                         | Breath always fogs.                       |

|              |                                                     |                                                               |                                                    |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Dragon       | Ice freezes liquids 10m radius                      | 50m lethal cold 30s, you immune                               | Frost on held items.                               |
| Metal Dragon | Bend non-relic metal at touch. Metal -20%           | Iron Body 1/day — skin = steel 1min. +80% blunt/pierce resist | Blood silver. Metal sticks to skin.                |
| Space Dragon | Fold-Silk pouches hold 2× for you. Space +50% range | Step Through 1/day — teleport 1 mile to known place           | Depth perception off. Objects look wrong distance. |

## XVII. ARCADIA

**Role:** World's only neutral academy city. Outside any regional political control. Central hub for education, research, and cross-civilizational exchange.

**College Leadership:** Dean → Vice Dean → Senior Professors → Professors → Lecturers/Instructors → Exam Masters → Field Supervisors

### Colleges

| College               | Focus                                           |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| College of the Blade  | Combat, weapons, martial skill                  |
| College of the Arcane | Magic theory, spell research, elemental mastery |
| College of the Spirit | Spirit pacts, sacred arts, ancestral magic      |
| College of the Veil   | Espionage, covert arts, infiltration            |
| College of the Forge  | Artifice, rune-craft, engineering               |
| College of the World  | Politics, history, diplomacy, trade             |
| College of the Ki     | Internal force, body cultivation                |

**College of the Ki Subdisciplines:** Breath Arts · Meridian Flow · Iron Body Arts · Swift Step Arts · Pressure Arts · Endurance Arts · Ki Weapon Arts · Life Flow Arts

### Houses

| House | Identity | Rivals |
|-------|----------|--------|
|-------|----------|--------|



|              |                                       |                     |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------|
| House Aster  | Balanced, prestigious, competitive    | Veyr, Thorne        |
| House Lumen  | Scholarly, healing, diplomatic        | Sable               |
| House Veyr   | Aggressive, tactical, ambitious       | Aster, Thorne       |
| House Sable  | Secretive, clever, information-minded | Lumen               |
| House Solace | Cooperative, stable, socially skilled | Thorne              |
| House Thorne | Proud, stubborn, disciplined          | Aster, Veyr, Solace |

**Student Organizations:** Student Council · Duel Society · Expedition Club · Research Circle · Relic Study Society · Spirit Study Association · Forge Club · Veil Club · World Forum Society · Monster Field Group

**Landmarks:** Grand Arcadia Academy · The Grand Gate · The Hall of Concord · The Hall of Founders · The Archive Spire · The Collegium Towers · The Hall of Practical Arts · The Research Annexes · The Trial Arena · The Field Grounds · The Labyrinth Grounds · The Sky Bridges · Adventurer Guild Headquarters · The Contract Hall · The Mission Board Plaza · The Civic Exchange · Residential Commons · The Market of Many Realms · The Relic Ward · The Diplomatic Forum · The Hall of Graduation · The Monument Circle · The Watchtower of Scholars

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## XVIII. VAMPIRES

**Overview:** Rare and secretive. More common than angels, demons, and pure dragons. Hidden cities or kingdoms. 90% magic awakening. Blood converts to mana at 2:1 ratio. Tri-Blooded common. 10% ki awakening rate — extremely rare. Dangerous but vulnerable to exposure.

### Hierarchy

1. **Progenitors** — Oldest, rarest, strongest bloodlines. The apex of vampire society.
2. **Pure Bloods** — Noble descendants of progenitors.
3. **Regular Vampires** — Turned vampires, mixed lines, and lesser branches.

**Progenitor Houses:** House Nocthyr · House Velcora · House Dravane · House Veyrath · House Morlune · House Sanguivar

**Pure Blood Lines:** Blackthorn Line · Crimson Veil Line · Nightrose Line · Silver Fang Line · Pale Court Line · Velvet Dusk Line · Roseblood Line · Moonfang Line · Thornblood Line ·

**Regular Houses:** House Vael · House Corven · House Drev · House Sorn · House Rhyss · House Thale · House Velin · House Marrow · House Kyrn · House Neris

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## XIX. ASHFALL — THE PIT

**Official Name:** Ashfall | **Nickname:** The Pit **Location:** Contested border between North and Frontier, built in a dead leyline scar. **Rulers:** The Nine Coins — 9 crime lords. Assassination = promotion. **Core Identity:** Crime is law. Power makes rules. Everything has a price. **Nine Coins Rule:** Kill 1 Coin, 2 more rise. Oathslate binds succession. Only way to break the Nine Coins = destroy Ashfall itself.

### Districts

| # | District        | Description                                                                                                                                               |
|---|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | The Underbelly  | Black market heart. Slave pens, forbidden tomes, relic auctions, Nullstone smuggling, Cold Iron weapon forges.                                            |
| 2 | Gilded Maw      | Massive casino-hub + gambling district. Dice halls, fight pits, card dens, beast races. 20+ rival houses run tables. Neutral ground by necessity.         |
| 3 | Crimson Circle  | Colosseum complex. Blood Pits (no-rules death matches), Glory Rings (sanctioned duels — Cold Iron cages = pure skill), Beast Yards (ki user vs monsters). |
| 4 | Gutter Boroughs | Slums. 80% of city. Assassins, thieves, body harvesters, illegal Spirit Pact brokers.                                                                     |
| 5 | Free Docks      | Airship + smuggling port. Stolen Arcadia tomes, black-market sect drugs, Miraj nullstone dust.                                                            |

### Rules

1. No official guards. Hire your own.
  2. Debts paid in blood, mana, years, or family. Debt brokers use Oath Magic.
  3. Nullstone shackles legal. Cold Iron legal. Dead leyline = Law Spells cost 10× mana, duration –90% (10s max). Impractical, not impossible.
  4. If you're strong enough to take it, it's yours.
-

## XX. MATERIALS & MINERALS

*All materials found globally. Ashfall is a trade hub, not the source.*

### Anti-Magic/Ki

#### Cold Iron — Uncommon

- –80% mana/ki flow. Very durable. Burns spirits and beasts on contact.
- Special Rule: Nullstone cancels the –80% effect — inside a Nullstone field, Cold Iron is just durable metal. Must choose block vs drain, not both.
- Source: North deep mines, Dwarven forge-hardened
- Uses: Shackles, anti-mage blades, Sealing Order weapons, Glory Ring cages
- Counters: Saint Realm / Grand Archmage brute force

#### Nullstone — Rare

- Complete mana/ki block. Creates dead zone 1–10m radius.
- Special Rule: Cancels Cold Iron's –80% drain.
- Source: Miraj desert cores, leyline scars
- Uses: Prison cells, anti-magic bombs, smuggling containers, Underbelly trade
- Counters: Pure brute force only — no magic/ki bypass

### Forging & Enhancement

#### Aetherium — Rare

- +40% mana efficiency. Pathways heal 3x faster. Burns out after ~1,000 spells — crumbles to dust. Non-renewable.
- Source: Arcadia Sky Islands, high altitude only
- Uses: Mage staff cores, Sovereign Archon robes, Archive vault locks
- Counters: Nullstone, Cold Iron, Decay Magic

#### Dreadiron — Uncommon

- Cuts mana constructs. Non-magical edge stays sharp 100 years.
- Source: North meteorites, quenched in Dark Magic

- Uses: Anti-mage greatswords, Sealing Order executioner blades
- Counters: Holy Magic rusts it, Light spells chip it

### **Sunsilver** — Rare

- Stores Light Magic. Blade glows, burns undead and Dark users on contact.
- Source: Miraj mirror-deserts, only forms under solstice sun
- Uses: Templar swords, vampire-hunting arrows, South elf spears
- Counters: Dark Magic corrodes, Nullstone drains charge

### **Gravethread** — Very Rare

- Flexible, durable as Cold Iron wire. Mana conductive. Self-repairing. +15% efficiency for channeled spells/arts.
- Source: Subterranean shroud moths in abandoned fortresses. 1 nest per century per site.
- Uses: Archmage/Grandmaster battle robes, Spellblade gloves, ki wraps, bow strings, relic binding, high-end Spell Tomes
- Counters: Law Spells, sustained Calamity Spell, Fire + Dark combo melts permanently

### **Kingshield Oak** — Very Rare

- Wood as hard as Cold Iron. Regrows if planted.
- Source: Old war sites. 1 tree per century.
- Uses: Sovereign Archon tower shields, fortress gates
- Counters: Fire + Decay Magic only

## **Elemental Mana Crystals**

### **Special Rules:**

- Only 1 crystal attunes per person. Second crystal = 50% chance both shatter.
- User Bonus: 100% effect for mages, 30% for pure ki users, 70% for dual users/blessed.
- All shatter if struck by Cold Iron. Safe to smuggle in a Nullstone box.
- Max damage = War Spell equivalent. Not city-level. Siege Spell still needs Master+ mage.

| Crystal | Rarity | Element | Power | Shatter | Rarity/Frequency | Counters |
|---------|--------|---------|-------|---------|------------------|----------|
|         |        |         |       |         |                  | Earth    |

|                  |      |           |                                                              |                                                          |                                                        |                                                                             |
|------------------|------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Voltcrystal      | Rare | Lightning | +60%<br>Lightning                                            | 20m<br>radius<br>burst,<br>War<br>Spell                  | 1 per decade<br>globally                               | grounds,<br>Cold Iron<br>shorts,<br>Water<br>destabilizes                   |
| Cinderheart      | Rare | Fire      | +60%<br>Fire, blade<br>red-hot                               | 15m<br>fireball +<br>molten<br>shrapnel,<br>War<br>Spell | Volcanic<br>battlefields<br>500yr+ old                 | Water/Ice<br>quenches,<br>Cold Iron<br>smothers,<br>sand buries             |
| Seaglass<br>Core | Rare | Water     | +60%<br>Water,<br>creates<br>water<br>from air               | 30m<br>pressure<br>burst,<br>War<br>Spell                | 1 per century,<br>South ocean<br>trenches 10km<br>down | Fire<br>evaporates,<br>Lightning<br>destabilizes,<br>drought<br>weakens     |
| Rimeheart        | Rare | Ice       | +60% Ice,<br>area 5m<br>drops<br>40°C                        | 20m<br>flash-<br>freeze,<br>War<br>Spell                 | 1 per 50 years,<br>North glacier<br>hearts             | Fire melts,<br>Earth<br>insulates,<br>saltwater<br>resists                  |
| Galeheart        | Rare | Wind      | +60%<br>Wind,<br>lightens<br>wielder,<br>+silent<br>movement | 25m<br>razor<br>wind<br>burst,<br>War<br>Spell           | 1 per decade, eye<br>of century storms                 | Earth<br>blocks,<br>heavy armor<br>resists,<br>enclosed<br>spaces<br>dampen |
| Terracore        | Rare | Earth     | +60%<br>Earth,<br>wielder<br>+300%<br>weight at<br>will      | 15m<br>localized<br>quake,<br>War<br>Spell               | 1 per century,<br>tectonic fault<br>lines              | Wind<br>erodes,<br>Water turns<br>to mud,<br>Lightning<br>shatters          |
| Dawnglass        | Rare | Light     | +60%<br>Light,<br>purges<br>Dark on<br>contact,              | 20m<br>blinding<br>flash +<br>holy fire,                 | 1 per 25 years,<br>Miraj at dawn<br>solstice           | Dark clouds<br>it, Nullstone<br>drains,<br>underground                      |

|           |      |      |                                                                   |                                                      |                                                |                                                  |
|-----------|------|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
|           |      |      | burns<br>undead                                                   | War<br>Spell                                         |                                                | weakens                                          |
| Duskstone | Rare | Dark | +60%<br>Dark,<br>drains<br>light/heat<br>3m,<br>silences<br>sound | 20m<br>darkness<br>+ decay<br>pulse,<br>War<br>Spell | 1 per 25 years,<br>sites of mass<br>executions | Light<br>purges, Holy<br>shatters, fire<br>burns |

## Ki Materials

### Special Rules:

- Only 1 ki ore/crystal attunes per person. Skyforged + Lifesilk = ok. 2× Skyforged = unstable.
- Mixing with mana crystal = 50% shatter risk for both.
- Cold Iron / Nullstone counter all. No material is immune.
- Skyforged + Lifesilk = light armor meta. Kingshield Oak + Dreadiron = heavy armor meta.

### Skyforged Steel — Uncommon (Ki-Conductive Ore)

- 60% weight of steel, 120% durability. +40% ki output, –20% technique cost. Hard as Dreadiron when ki-infused, normal steel without. Overcharge = 24hr dull period.
- Source: Sky Island meteorites that absorbed century-storms. Forged at high altitude only.
- Uses: Ki blades, spear heads, light plate armor, Spellblade foci. Preferred for Saint+ who need speed and flow.
- Counters: Cold Iron drains flow bonus, Nullstone makes mundane steel, sustained Decay rusts it

### Lifesilk — Rare (Ki-Conductive Thread)

- Weaves like silk, tensile strength of Cold Iron wire. +40% ki efficiency through it. Self-mending: cut thread re-knits in 5min (fire/melting stops this). Full suit weighs 2kg. Conducts only — does not store ki. Cannot block fatal blows.
- Source: Ki moths in ancient dojos. Moths eat ambient ki from 100+ years of training. 1 nest per 80 years.
- Uses: Light armor underlayers, ki wraps, bowstrings, wire weapons, relic binding,

meridian acupuncture needles

- Counters: Law Spells sever connection, Void Shard cuts permanently, Fire + Dark melts, sustained Calamity Spell burns out conductivity

## **Artifact & Relic Materials**

### **Starstone** — Very Rare

- Crystallized starlight. Under open sky: +40% to all magic/ki. 1/day Combat Spell starfire beam. Kept in total darkness 1 month: charges 1 use of Starless Night (Combat Spell darkness field). 3–5 fall per century globally.
- Source: Mountaintops during meteor showers
- Uses: Archmage astrolabes, Eclipse Magic foci, South elf crowns, navigation relics, subterranean tactics
- Counters: Daylight = inert, Decay Magic clouds permanently, Nullstone blocks starlight

### **Leyglass** — Very Rare

- Stores raw leyline mana. 1 shard = 1 Combat Spell free. 20% chance to shatter on use = mana backlash.
- Source: Forms where leylines erupt violently
- Uses: Adept/Expert emergency battery, trap components, Arcadia Spire cores
- Counters: Cold Iron grounds it, dropping = small detonation

### **Spirit Iron** — Legendary

- Can harm spirits directly. Binds Noble+ spirits on contact.
- Source: Forged in Spirit Realm by Royal spirits, traded for favors
- Uses: Spirit hunters, Veiled Order, Qinzhou exorcist blades
- Counters: Charity blessing frees bound spirit. Sovereign spirits shatter it by touch. Royal spirits break it after 10min contact.

### **Worldroot Amber** — Legendary

- Regrows anything placed inside: limbs, Mana Hall, Meridians. Heals up to Expert/Master stage damage. Archmage+ damage requires 10× Amber + 1 year submersion. Sovereign/Heaven-Opening damage = incurable.
- Source: World Tree sap fossilized over 10,000 years

- Uses: South elf healing relics, cures Pathway Scorch/Meridian Damage up to Master stage
- Counters: Fire + Dark combo melts permanently

## Utility & Covert Materials

### Whispering Lead — Uncommon

- Blocks Divination and Scrying. Whispers secrets of past owners.
- Source: Frontier cursed mines
- Uses: Anti-spy vaults, Hollowreach deal rooms, assassin masks
- Counters: Holy Magic silences whispers, Sound Magic shatters

### Oathslate — Rare

- Written pact on it = unbreakable unless slate is physically destroyed.
- Source: North oath-mountains
- Uses: Nine Coins contracts, marriage bonds, mage guild charters
- Counters: Law Spell "I deny this oath"

### Wraithweave — Rare

- Cloth + Dark Magic. Passively bends light. +Silent Casting. –20% presence.
- Source: South shadow marshes, made by Dark sects
- Uses: Assassin suits, Veiled Order robes
- Counters: Light Magic reveals, Cold Iron pins it

## Elemental Resist Materials

**Drowned Oak** — Uncommon: +20% Water/Dark resist. From 100yr sunken ships. Counters: Fire burns fast, sinks in fresh water. **Sun-Slate** — Uncommon: +30% Fire/Light resist. Miraj desert 100yr bake. Counters: Brittle to Cold Iron. **Galeheart Wood** — Uncommon: +30% Wind/Lightning resist. Arcadian cliff trees. Counters: Ignites easily. **Still-Lead** — Uncommon: +10% resist all mana. Heavy, toxic. Nullstone-lite. Counters: Weight limits mobility. **Frostiron** — Uncommon: +40% Ice resist, –20% Fire resist. North ore. Best for Frostborn bloodline.

## Subspace Materials

**Stacking Rule:** Pouches do NOT stack. Fold-Silk inside Fold-Silk = both unravel. Nullstone cancels access to all subspace storage.

---



| Material        | Rarity    | Properties                                                                                                       | Cost                                           | Counters                                        |
|-----------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Fold-Silk       | Uncommon  | 1m <sup>2</sup> = 2m <sup>2</sup> interior, 1ft <sup>3</sup> volume                                              | 50 gold                                        | Overstuff = Astral tear, contents lost          |
| Vault-Weave     | Rare      | Fold-Silk + Gravethread + Master Rune. 1m <sup>2</sup> = 10m <sup>2</sup> , 5ft <sup>3</sup> , holds weight      | 500 gold                                       | Cold Iron cut = collapse, contents eject safely |
| Pocket-Seam     | Very Rare | Keyed to owner's blood. Others open = appears empty. Theft = Glyph triggers Combat Spell                         | 2,000+ gold                                    | Owner's death breaks seal                       |
| Worldhold Cloth | Legendary | Cloak = 20×20ft room interior. Requires 5% mana tithe. Owner death = room persists 100 years then dumps contents | Sovereign Archon + Space Sovereign co-creation | 5% mana tithe ongoing                           |

## XXI. LORE & SYSTEMS

### Combat Culture by Region

**Dual Users:** ~1 in 10,000 born with capacity. ~1 in 100,000 advance both past Expert/Master.

**Natural Attunement:** Some bloodlines lean mana, some ki, some neither. Talent + preference take priority. Not everyone creates — some create, some refine, some master existing arts.

| Region          | Combat Style                                                                                          |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Orinthia (West) | Mana focus, but knights train blade + mana equally. Staff, sword, wand all common. No stigma.         |
| Qin Zhou (East) | Martial sects dominate. Sword/Spear/Polearm + Ki standard. Mana users fewer. Staff = fine, just rare. |
| South Elves     | Bow-Mage standard. Ki users present. Grace over force.                                                |
|                 | Axe/Hammer + Frost Magic or pure Ki. Dual users distrusted — “no loyalty to                           |

|          |                                                                        |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| North    | one path."                                                             |
| Frontier | Whatever works. Spellblade mercenaries common but burn out young.      |
| Miraj    | Curved blades + Sun Magic or pure Ki. Staff = priest caste, respected. |
| Arcadia  | Teaches all paths. No caste — talent only.                             |

## Combat Clarifications

### War Spell vs War Art:

- War Spell: 300m radius, 10min cast, terrain warped 100yr. Role: siege and bombardment.
- War Art: 50m radius, 30s charge, precision. Role: anti-army and bunker busting.
- Different roles. Both are needed. Neither replaces the other.

### Sovereign vs Heaven-Opening Matchups:

- Base split: 45/55. Terrain, prep, and ability matchup decide actual odds. Stage = potential, not guarantee.
- Sovereign Archon vs Heaven-Opening [Water] in volcano = Archon 70/30
- Same matchup in ocean = Heaven-Opening 80/20
- Same element, open field = 50/50 — first mistake loses
- Legends exist because they beat the odds.

## Alchemy — Give and Take, Production Based

**World Laws** (placed by The Arbiter Entity — violation = Alchemical Backlash, brewer pays with their body):

1. No creation from nothing. Every potion needs mass + energy input.
2. No permanent ascension. Elixirs cap at +5% stat, temporary or with side effects.
3. No life creation. Can heal, not resurrect.
4. No law-breaking potions.

| Tier   | Level   | Effect                   | Time | Cost  |
|--------|---------|--------------------------|------|-------|
| Salves | Cantrip | Heal cuts, stop bleeding | 1hr  | Herbs |
|        |         |                          |      |       |

|               |               |                                                               |            |                                                  |
|---------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Potions       | Combat Spell  | +50% strength/speed/regen 10min.<br>Overdose 3/day = backlash | 1hr        | Leyglass dust +<br>beast core                    |
| Elixirs       | War Spell     | Permanent +5% stat OR cure 1<br>incurable                     | 1<br>week  | Ki crystal +<br>Archmage blood +<br>1yr lifespan |
| Grand Elixirs | Archmage tier | Mimic 1 War Spell/Art for 1min                                | 1<br>month | Voltcrystal shard +<br>10yr lifespan             |

Not a combat class. Needs lab + time + materials. Cannot quick-brew in combat.

## Runes — Inscription Magic/Ki

Write mana/ki into matter. Effect triggers on condition. **No Law Runes exist.** Takes time — no quick-cast. Destroy rune = destroy effect. Dispel works. Nullstone blocks.

| Type         | Level             | Effect                                                               | Carve Time      |
|--------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Wards        | Adept             | Passive defense. "Deny Fire" on door = –50% Fire Spells              | 1 day           |
| Glyphs       | Master            | Single-use offense. "Explode" on sword = Combat Spell on hit         | 1 week          |
| Arrays       | Grandmaster+ team | Teleport circles, flying ship cores, city barriers                   | Months to years |
| Master Runes | Archmage          | "Teleport 1 mile" or "Nullstone Field 10m" — burns out after 10 uses | 1 month         |

Best materials: Cold Iron (100yr) · Gravethread/Lifesilk (cloth) · Sunsilver (Light only). Users: Arcadia Rune Scribes · North Dwarven Runesmiths · Frontier trap makers.

## Summoning — Contract Magic

Rental, not creation. **No Law Summon.** Summoned entities are not loyal — need Oathslate contract or they turn. Nullstone = no summoning. Cold Iron weakens link. Best = 1–3 per fight.

| Type          | Level        | Effect                                                             | Risk                                     |
|---------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Spirit Summon | Combat Spell | Call Minor-True spirit for 1 fight. Spirit can refuse. 1hr ritual. | Death = banished 100yr, spirit hates you |
| Beast         |              | Call tamed beast from Beast Realm. Needs                           | Beast permanently                        |

|                  |           |                                                                          |                        |
|------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Summon           | Ki Art    | prior bond. Beast can die for real.                                      | dead if killed         |
| Elemental Summon | War Spell | Call elemental. Needs crystal as beacon. 10min. Rampages if binder dies. | Rampage if binder dies |

Users: East Spirit Callers · South Beast Tamers · Arcadia Elementalists · Frontier (disposable summons)

## XXII. BEASTBOUND

Nine Sovereign-tier Calamity Spirits sealed into human bloodlines at birth. Soul Bound, inherited, spread globally. **One per major region per Treaty of Nine.**

### Binding Rules

- Sealed to soul at birth via Fleshscript + Oathslate + Land Pact ritual.
- Cannot be removed, stolen, or transferred except by death.
- On death: Chosen Heir ritual = 90% success to kin newborn. Forced Rebirth = 10% — nearest compatible newborn within 100 miles.
- Tithe: 5% pool passive. Active draw scales 5–20% pool/min based on Shroud Version.
- No Twins: Only 1 Beast per soul. Twin birth = Beast picks one, other becomes Hollow = –50% lifespan.

### The Nine Beasts

| # | Name     | Tails       | Element    | Region                | Ability                                    |
|---|----------|-------------|------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Shukaku  | One Tail    | Wind/Sand  | Miraj deserts         | Absolute sand control. Defense specialist. |
| 2 | Matatabi | Two Tails   | Fire       | North volcanic fields | Blue fire that clings like oil.            |
| 3 | Isobu    | Three Tails | Water      | Orinthia coasts       | Armor shell, mist and illusion.            |
| 4 | Son Goku | Four Tails  | Earth/Lava | Qinzhou mountains     | Lava release, taijutsu boost.              |
| 5 | Kokuo    | Five        | Steam      | Frontier geysers      | Steam pressure, speed and                  |

|   |        |             |             |                               |                                       |
|---|--------|-------------|-------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
|   |        | Tails       |             |                               | power.                                |
| 6 | Saiken | Six Tails   | Acid        | South marshes                 | Acid slime, self and host healing.    |
| 7 | Chomei | Seven Tails | Wind/Bug    | Arcadia forests               | Flight, scales, blinding powder.      |
| 8 | Gyuki  | Eight Tails | Water/Ink   | Orinthia island chain         | Ink seals, 8 limbs for 8x Flash Arts. |
| 9 | Kurama | Nine Tails  | Fire/Malice | Disputed — last seen Frontier | Raw ki amplification. Senses malice.  |

## Calamity Shroud Versions

| Version       | Stage Req                | Tails     | Power                                                     | Cost         | Risk                                    |
|---------------|--------------------------|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------|
| V1 Shroud     | Adept/Flow               | 1 tail    | +1 Stage stats. Wounds heal at Surge Art level.           | 5% pool/min  | Emotions bleed. Lose control at 50% hp. |
| V2 Shroud     | Expert/Surge             | 2–4 tails | Bone armor. +2 Stages. Claws = Combat Spell damage.       | 10% pool/min | Skin peels. 1hr coma after.             |
| Partial Beast | Master/Manifest          | 5–7 tails | Manifest body part. Edict Art tier.                       | 15% pool/min | Beast speaks. Dispel = Meridian Damage. |
| Full Beast    | Grand Archmage/Domain    | 8–9 tails | Become the Beast. Calamity Spell tier.                    | 20% pool/min | If host dies, Beast rampages 100 years. |
| Unity         | Saint/Edict + deep trust | All       | No cloak. Host + Beast sync. Law Art tier. 30min/day max. | 30% pool/min | 3 days exhaustion after.                |

Tail Count Limit: 1-Tail host cannot access 9-Tail V2 Shroud. Host stage + trust + tail count all gate access.

## **Politics & Counters**

### **Treaty of Nine** (Oathslate-backed):

- No hunting other nations' Beastbound.
- No using 2 Beasts in the same war.
- Break = other 8 nations retaliate.
- Each Beast tied to regional clan. Example: Miraj's Sabaku clan hold Shukaku. Clan = nobility + hostages.
- Arcadia runs Beast Census. Tracks hosts, seal status, leaks. Mediates disputes.

### **Counters:**

- Cold Iron chains = suppress to V1 max.
- Nullstone field = can't draw Beast ki. Existing cloak remains.
- Law Spell "Be still" = 10s forced shutdown. Costs caster 5 years lifespan.
- Beast vs Beast: more tails wins direct clash.

## **Interactions**

- Ascension: Beastbound can ascend. Beast does not get stronger — host baseline rises.
- Blessings: Stack with Beastbound. Pure Dragon Fire + Kurama = legal.
- Dual Awakened: Possible. Odds = 1 per 1 million years.
- Immortality: Beast does not grant immortality. Host ages normally.